

L I V   F U N C T I O N A L

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# The 90-Day Thyroid Reset

*Volume II — The Holistic Path*

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A food-first, lifestyle-led protocol for women navigating  
thyroid symptoms without medication.

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CERTIFIED HOLISTIC NUTRITION COACH

# Read This First

This is not a medical protocol. I am not a doctor. I am not a dietitian. I am a holistic nutrition coach who reversed her own metabolic and autoimmune mess by getting honest about what her body needed — and I test everything on myself before I bring it to you.

## THIS 90-DAY RESET IS FOR THE WOMAN WHO:

- Feels exhausted no matter how much she sleeps
- Has gained weight that won't move with diet or exercise
- Is cold when no one else is
- Notices her hair thinning, eyebrows fading, or skin drying out
- Has brain fog, mood swings, or low motivation
- Suspects her thyroid is part of the problem — but isn't on Levothyroxine yet

## WHO THIS IS NOT FOR

- Women already taking Levothyroxine, Synthroid, Armour, or any thyroid replacement → use Volume I.
- Women who are pregnant, breastfeeding, or trying to conceive without medical supervision.
- Women with active eating disorders or untreated severe mental health conditions.
- Women on lithium, amiodarone, or other medications that affect thyroid function — speak to your prescriber first.

## BEFORE YOU START

You don't need labs to do this protocol. The whole plan is built around food, lifestyle, and lifestyle-grade supplements safe for the general adult population. But you should still get tested if you can — see Appendix A for the full panel.

## STOP AND SEE A DOCTOR IMMEDIATELY IF

- Your resting heart rate is over 100 or you have palpitations
- You experience sudden, unexplained weight loss
- You have a visible lump in your throat or trouble swallowing
- You become severely fatigued, confused, or develop puffiness around the eyes
- You feel persistently depressed or have thoughts of harming yourself

This protocol supports your body. It does not replace medical care.

# How to Use This Protocol

**Three phases. Twelve weeks. Layered, not stacked.**

## THE ARC

- **Phase 1 (Weeks 1–4) — Remove.** Take the foot off the inflammation pedal. Stabilize blood sugar. Restore sleep. Heal the gut.
- **Phase 2 (Weeks 5–8) — Rebuild.** Replenish the minerals and nutrients your thyroid needs to make and convert hormone.
- **Phase 3 (Weeks 9–12) — Regulate.** Train your nervous system, your hormones, and your habits to hold the new baseline.

## WHAT EACH WEEK GIVES YOU

- A theme and why it matters
- Hero foods — your food-as-medicine list
- One signature meal
- Supplement stack with exact timing
- One breathwork practice (5 minutes or less)
- One meditation practice
- A daily non-negotiable
- A workbook page — reflection prompts, a 7-day tracker, and space for notes

## RULES OF ENGAGEMENT

1. **Do not skip Phase 1.** The supplements in Phase 2 don't work if your gut is inflamed and your blood sugar is on a rollercoaster. Resist the urge.
2. **Add, don't subtract.** Each week builds on the last. By Week 12, you are doing all of it — but you didn't try to do all of it on Day 1.
3. **Track everything.** Symptoms, energy, sleep, mood, cycle, weight, body temperature on waking. The thyroid is slow. Subtle progress is still progress.
4. **Eight hours of sleep is not optional.** It is the protocol.

# The Starter Kit

*Buy this before Week 1. Don't buy everything at once after that — each week tells you what to add.*

## PANTRY BASICS

- Sea salt or pink Himalayan salt
- Extra virgin olive oil (cold-pressed)
- Coconut oil
- Ghee or grass-fed butter
- Apple cider vinegar with the mother
- Bone broth (organic, or homemade)
- Brazil nuts (raw, refrigerated)
- Pumpkin seeds, sunflower seeds
- Wild blueberries (frozen)
- Loose-leaf green tea

## TOOLS

- Glass or stainless steel water bottle (no plastic)
- Basal body thermometer (pharmacy)
- A simple journal — paper, not an app
- Timer for breathwork (your phone, on airplane mode)

## FOUNDATIONAL SUPPLEMENTS (WEEK 1 STACK)

| Supplement           | Dose           | Notes                                |
|----------------------|----------------|--------------------------------------|
| Magnesium glycinate  | 300–400 mg     | Calms nervous system, supports sleep |
| Vitamin D3 + K2      | 2,000–5,000 IU | Test first if possible               |
| Omega-3 (EPA/DHA)    | 1,000–2,000 mg | Reduces inflammation                 |
| Methylated B-complex | 1 capsule      | Methylfolate, methylcobalamin        |

P H A S E   O N E   ·   W E E K S   1 – 4

# Remove

*Take the foot off the inflammation pedal.*

WEEK ONE

# The Reset Foundation

*Theme: Stop putting fuel on the fire.*

You cannot heal a thyroid while you keep flooding the system with the things that inflame it. Week 1 is about removal — not deprivation. We are clearing space.

**REMOVE FOR THE NEXT 90 DAYS**

- Gluten — full stop. Even if you are not celiac. Gluten cross-reacts with thyroid tissue.
- Refined sugar and high-fructose corn syrup
- Industrial seed oils — canola, soybean, corn, sunflower, safflower, "vegetable oil"
- Alcohol
- Ultra-processed foods — anything with a label your grandmother wouldn't recognize
- Soy in any form except occasional fermented soy (miso, tempeh)

**HERO FOODS THIS WEEK**

- Wild-caught salmon, sardines, mackerel
- Pasture-raised eggs
- Avocado
- Leafy greens — spinach, arugula, romaine
- Bone broth

**SIGNATURE MEAL**

Soft-scrambled eggs in ghee with sautéed spinach, half an avocado, sea salt, and a side of warm bone broth. Eat within 60 minutes of waking. This is your new breakfast template.

**SUPPLEMENT STACK**

| Supplement             | Dose           | When                      | Notes                                |
|------------------------|----------------|---------------------------|--------------------------------------|
| Magnesium glycinate    | 300 mg         | 30 min before bed         | Calms nervous system                 |
| Vitamin D3 + K2        | 2,000–5,000 IU | With breakfast (with fat) | Fat-soluble — never on empty stomach |
| Omega-3 EPA/DHA        | 1,000 mg       | With dinner               | With food to avoid burping           |
| B-complex (methylated) | 1 capsule      | With breakfast            | Energy and stress support            |

**BREATHWORK — BOX BREATHING (4-4-4-4)**

Three minutes, twice a day (morning and before bed). Inhale 4, hold 4, exhale 4, hold 4. Shifts you out of fight-or-flight and into the parasympathetic state where healing happens.

**MEDITATION — 5-MINUTE BODY SCAN**

Lie down. Close your eyes. Move attention slowly from the crown of your head to the soles of your feet. Notice without judgment. If you fall asleep, you needed it.

## DAILY NON-NEGOTIABLE

500 ml of water with a pinch of sea salt and the juice of half a lemon within 30 minutes of waking. Before coffee.

## Week 1 Workbook

### REFLECTION PROMPTS

1. *What did I remove this week that I didn't think I could?*
2. *Which trigger food am I most attached to — and why?*
3. *What surprised me about how my body responded?*

### 7-DAY TRACKER

| Day | Energy AM | Energy PM | Sleep (hrs) | BM | Mood (1–10) | Cravings |
|-----|-----------|-----------|-------------|----|-------------|----------|
| Mon |           |           |             |    |             |          |
| Tue |           |           |             |    |             |          |
| Wed |           |           |             |    |             |          |
| Thu |           |           |             |    |             |          |
| Fri |           |           |             |    |             |          |
| Sat |           |           |             |    |             |          |
| Sun |           |           |             |    |             |          |

### MY WINS THIS WEEK

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### MY CHALLENGES THIS WEEK

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### WHAT I'M NOTICING IN MY BODY

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WEEK TWO

# Blood Sugar Steady

*Theme: Stop the rollercoaster.*

Insulin resistance and thyroid dysfunction are best friends. A blood-sugar spike triggers cortisol, cortisol blocks T4-to-T3 conversion, and you spend the day exhausted and craving sugar. We break the cycle this week.

## THE FOUR BLOOD-SUGAR RULES — START TODAY, DO THEM FOR 90 DAYS

- 1. **Protein first.** Every meal starts with 25–40 g of protein. Eat the protein before the carbs.
- 2. **No naked carbs.** Never eat a carb alone. Always pair with protein, fat, or fiber.
- 3. **No grazing.** Three meals, optionally one small snack. Stop eating after dinner.
- 4. **Walk 10 minutes after meals.** A short walk after eating cuts post-meal glucose spikes by up to 30%.

## HERO FOODS THIS WEEK

- Pasture-raised chicken thighs
- Grass-fed ground beef
- Lentils and chickpeas
- Ceylon (true) cinnamon
- Low-glycemic berries — blueberries, raspberries, blackberries
- Apple cider vinegar

## SIGNATURE MEAL

Grass-fed beef burger (no bun) on a bed of arugula with sliced tomato, half an avocado, sauerkraut, and roasted sweet potato wedges. Drizzle with olive oil and apple cider vinegar.

## SUPPLEMENT STACK — ADD TO WEEK 1

| Supplement          | Dose            | When                       | Notes                                |
|---------------------|-----------------|----------------------------|--------------------------------------|
| Berberine           | 500 mg          | 15 min before largest meal | Skip if pregnant or on diabetes meds |
| Chromium picolinate | 200 mcg         | With lunch                 | Stabilizes blood sugar               |
| Apple cider vinegar | 1 tbsp in water | Before lunch and dinner    | Blunts glucose spikes                |

## BREATHWORK — 4-7-8 BREATHING

Inhale through the nose for 4. Hold for 7. Exhale through the mouth for 8. Four rounds, before each meal. Activates the vagus nerve and prepares your gut to digest.

## MEDITATION — EATING MEDITATION

Once this week. No phone, no TV, no book. Eat slowly. Notice texture, temperature, smell. Chew each bite 20 times. Notice when you are 80% full. Stop.



DAILY NON-NEGOTIABLE

Walk for 10 minutes after dinner. Outside if possible. No phone.

Week 2 Workbook

REFLECTION PROMPTS

- 1. When in the day did I crash hardest? What had I eaten before it?
- 2. What does "protein first" actually look like in my real life — at home, at work, traveling?
- 3. What emotion drives my sugar craving most often: stress, boredom, sadness, exhaustion?

7-DAY TRACKER

| Day | Protein at AM (g) | Energy crash time | Sugar craving (1–10) | Walks after meals | Notes |
|-----|-------------------|-------------------|----------------------|-------------------|-------|
| Mon |                   |                   |                      |                   |       |
| Tue |                   |                   |                      |                   |       |
| Wed |                   |                   |                      |                   |       |
| Thu |                   |                   |                      |                   |       |
| Fri |                   |                   |                      |                   |       |
| Sat |                   |                   |                      |                   |       |
| Sun |                   |                   |                      |                   |       |

WAIST MEASUREMENT (RECORD NOW): \_\_\_\_\_ CM/IN

WHAT'S SHIFTING

WEEK THREE

Circadian Reset

*Theme: Your thyroid runs on rhythm.*

The thyroid is exquisitely sensitive to circadian disruption. If your sleep, light exposure, and meal timing are chaotic, your thyroid will be too. This week we anchor the rhythm.

THE CIRCADIAN PROTOCOL

1. Morning sunlight within 30 minutes of waking — 10 minutes minimum. No sunglasses. No window glass.
2. Last meal 3 hours before bed.
3. No screens 60 minutes before bed — or wear blue-blocker glasses.
4. Cool, dark, quiet bedroom. 18–19°C. Blackout curtains. No LED lights.
5. Same wake time, every day. Including weekends.
6. Caffeine cutoff: noon. Earlier if sensitive.

HERO FOODS THIS WEEK

- Tart cherries (or 1 oz unsweetened tart cherry juice before bed)
- Kiwi — two before bed has been shown to improve sleep
- Pumpkin seeds
- Turkey, chicken — tryptophan
- Chamomile tea
- Magnesium-rich greens — Swiss chard, spinach

SIGNATURE MEAL

A "circadian dinner" — grilled wild salmon, roasted asparagus, half a baked sweet potato with butter, side of arugula. Eaten by 7 pm.

SUPPLEMENT STACK — ADD TO EXISTING

| Supplement                   | Dose             | When                         | Notes                                |
|------------------------------|------------------|------------------------------|--------------------------------------|
| Glycine                      | 3 g              | 30 min before bed (in water) | Lowers core body temp, deepens sleep |
| L-theanine                   | 200 mg           | After dinner                 | Calms without sedation               |
| Tart cherry extract or juice | Per label / 1 oz | 1 hour before bed            | Natural melatonin precursor          |

Avoid melatonin supplements unless prescribed. They can suppress your own production over time.

BREATHWORK — COHERENT BREATHING (5-5)

Inhale 5 seconds. Exhale 5 seconds. Ten minutes, before bed. The most-studied breath pattern for vagal tone and heart rate variability.

MEDITATION — YOGA NIDRA

20 minutes, before bed. Search "yoga nidra for sleep" on YouTube. Lie down, follow the audio. Three nights this week minimum. One session is reportedly equivalent to 2–3 hours of regular sleep in nervous-system terms.

DAILY NON-NEGOTIABLE

Get morning sunlight in your eyes within 30 minutes of waking — 10 minutes minimum.

Week 3 Workbook

REFLECTION PROMPTS

- 1. What time did I actually go to bed each night this week — and what got in the way?
- 2. How does my morning feel after a sunlight walk vs. without one?
- 3. What is my real relationship with my phone in bed?

7-DAY SLEEP & LIGHT TRACKER

| Day | Wake time | Sunlight (min) | Last meal | Bedtime | Sleep quality (1–10) | Basal temp (°C/F) |
|-----|-----------|----------------|-----------|---------|----------------------|-------------------|
| Mon |           |                |           |         |                      |                   |
| Tue |           |                |           |         |                      |                   |
| Wed |           |                |           |         |                      |                   |
| Thu |           |                |           |         |                      |                   |
| Fri |           |                |           |         |                      |                   |
| Sat |           |                |           |         |                      |                   |
| Sun |           |                |           |         |                      |                   |

WHAT'S SHIFTING

## WEEK FOUR

## Gut First

*Theme: You can't heal a thyroid through a leaky gut.*

Roughly 20% of T4 is converted to T3 in the gut. If your gut is inflamed, your conversion is broken — and the inflammation alone keeps cortisol high, which further blocks conversion.

## THE GUT PROTOCOL

1. Bone broth daily — 250–500 ml. Sip warm, between meals.
2. One fermented food daily — sauerkraut, kimchi, kefir, plain unsweetened yogurt, kombucha.
3. 30+ different plants per week. Variety drives microbiome diversity.
4. Chew. Each. Bite. 20+ times. Digestion starts in the mouth.
5. No water with meals. Sip a small amount only — too much dilutes stomach acid.

## HERO FOODS THIS WEEK

- Bone broth
- Sauerkraut and kimchi (raw, refrigerated section)
- Cooked-and-cooled rice or potatoes (resistant starch)
- Asparagus, garlic, onion, leek (prebiotics)
- Kiwi, papaya (digestive enzymes)
- Slippery elm tea

## SIGNATURE MEAL

A "healing bowl" — bone broth base, soft-poached chicken, zucchini noodles, soft-cooked carrots, ginger, a soft-boiled egg on top, spoonful of sauerkraut on the side, drizzle of olive oil.

## SUPPLEMENT STACK — ADD TO EXISTING

| Supplement               | Dose      | When                   | Notes                       |
|--------------------------|-----------|------------------------|-----------------------------|
| L-glutamine              | 5 g       | Morning, empty stomach | Repairs intestinal lining   |
| Probiotic (multi-strain) | 1 capsule | Before bed             | 5+ strains, 10+ billion CFU |
| Digestive enzymes        | 1 capsule | Start of largest meal  | Especially if you bloat     |
| Zinc carnosine           | 75 mg     | Morning, empty stomach | Heals stomach lining        |

## BREATHWORK — DIAPHRAGMATIC (BELLY) BREATHING

Lie on your back. One hand on chest, one on belly. Breathe so only the belly hand moves. Ten minutes per day. Stimulates the vagus nerve, which directly controls gut motility.

## MEDITATION — SELF-COMPASSION (10 MIN)

Think of one thing you've been hard on yourself about. Hand on heart. Say silently: "This is hard. Other women feel this too. May I be kind to myself." Repeat three times. Sit with it.

DAILY NON-NEGOTIABLE

One fermented food, every day. No exceptions.

Week 4 Workbook

REFLECTION PROMPTS

- 1. How many different plants did I actually eat this week? (Count vegetables, fruit, nuts, seeds, herbs, spices.)
- 2. What does my gut tell me when I slow down to listen?
- 3. Which fermented food has become a friend — and which one am I avoiding?

7-DAY GUT TRACKER

| Day | BM (yes/no) | Bristol stool type | Bloating (1–10) | Fermented food eaten | Plants today |
|-----|-------------|--------------------|-----------------|----------------------|--------------|
| Mon |             |                    |                 |                      |              |
| Tue |             |                    |                 |                      |              |
| Wed |             |                    |                 |                      |              |
| Thu |             |                    |                 |                      |              |
| Fri |             |                    |                 |                      |              |
| Sat |             |                    |                 |                      |              |
| Sun |             |                    |                 |                      |              |

30 PLANTS LIST — WRITE WHAT YOU ATE THIS WEEK

END OF PHASE 1 REFLECTION — WHAT'S ALREADY DIFFERENT?

PHASE TWO · WEEKS 5 – 8

# Rebuild

*Replenish the raw materials.*

WEEK FIVE

# The Mineral Foundation

*Theme: Selenium, zinc, magnesium — the thyroid's three best friends.*

Your thyroid cannot make hormone or convert it without minerals. Hashimoto's often correlates with selenium deficiency. Zinc is required for TSH receptor function. Magnesium is the conductor for over 300 enzymatic reactions, including thyroid hormone metabolism.

### HERO FOODS THIS WEEK

- Brazil nuts — 2–3 per day. **Do not exceed 4.** Selenium toxicity is real.
- Oysters and shellfish — highest food source of zinc on earth
- Pumpkin seeds — zinc and magnesium
- Grass-fed beef — zinc and iron
- Raw cacao — magnesium
- Dark leafy greens — magnesium

### SIGNATURE MEAL

Pan-seared grass-fed steak (4–6 oz), garlic-sautéed Swiss chard, baked sweet potato with butter, sprinkle of toasted pumpkin seeds. For dessert: 2 squares of 85%+ dark chocolate.

### SUPPLEMENT STACK — ADD TO EXISTING

| Supplement                     | Dose       | When                  | Notes                                                                                                       |
|--------------------------------|------------|-----------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Selenium (selenomethionine)    | 200 mcg    | Morning, with food    | Critical for T4→T3 conversion. Reduce or skip if eating Brazil nuts daily. Do not exceed 400 mcg/day total. |
| Zinc picolinate                | 15–30 mg   | Evening, with food    | Take 2 hours apart from copper-rich foods                                                                   |
| Magnesium glycinate (increase) | 400–600 mg | 200 mg AM / 400 mg PM | Reduce if loose stool                                                                                       |

### BREATHWORK — ALTERNATE NOSTRIL (NADI SHODHANA)

Close right nostril, inhale left. Close left, exhale right. Inhale right. Close right, exhale left. Five minutes, mid-afternoon. Balances the nervous system; reduces anxiety.

### MEDITATION — LOVING-KINDNESS (METTA)

10 minutes. Send well-wishes silently — to yourself, to a loved one, to a neutral person, to someone you struggle with, to all beings. *"May you be well. May you be at ease. May you be free from suffering."* Builds the nervous-system muscle that down-regulates inflammation.

### DAILY NON-NEGOTIABLE

Two Brazil nuts, every morning. With breakfast.

# Week 5 Workbook

## REFLECTION PROMPTS

- 1. How is my hair shedding compared to Week 1? (More / same / less)
- 2. How are my nails — strength, ridges, brittleness?
- 3. What does "well-nourished" feel like in my body now vs. four weeks ago?

## 7-DAY TRACKER

| Day | Brazil nuts | Hair (M/S/L) | Cold tolerance | Energy (1–10) | Mood (1–10) |
|-----|-------------|--------------|----------------|---------------|-------------|
| Mon |             |              |                |               |             |
| Tue |             |              |                |               |             |
| Wed |             |              |                |               |             |
| Thu |             |              |                |               |             |
| Fri |             |              |                |               |             |
| Sat |             |              |                |               |             |
| Sun |             |              |                |               |             |

## NOTES



WEEK SIX

# Iron & Energy

*Theme: Without ferritin, your thyroid hormone can't get off the bench.*

Low ferritin is rampant in women — especially women who menstruate, vegetarians, and women over 40 with subtle GI inflammation. Without enough iron, the thyroid can't synthesize hormone properly, T4 can't convert to T3, and tissues can't use the T3 you do have. Many women labeled "hypothyroid" are actually iron-deficient.

## HERO FOODS THIS WEEK

- Grass-fed beef liver — start with 1 oz blended into a burger
- Grass-fed beef
- Dark poultry meat
- Sardines
- Lentils and white beans (with vitamin C for absorption)
- Pumpkin seeds
- Spinach (cooked, not raw)
- Bell peppers, citrus, kiwi (vitamin C — pair with iron-rich meals)

## SIGNATURE MEAL

"Hidden liver burger" — 4 oz grass-fed ground beef blended with 1 oz beef liver, garlic, salt, pepper. Pan-seared. Served on sautéed spinach with a roasted bell pepper and a slice of orange. Vitamin C from the orange and pepper triples iron absorption.

## SUPPLEMENT STACK — ADD TO EXISTING

| Supplement             | Dose             | When                          | Notes                                                                                            |
|------------------------|------------------|-------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Iron bisglycinate      | 25 mg elemental  | Empty stomach, with vitamin C | Do NOT take with calcium, coffee, tea, or thyroid medication. Skip if ferritin is over 70 ng/mL. |
| Vitamin C (whole-food) | 500 mg           | With iron                     | Boosts iron absorption                                                                           |
| Methylated B-complex   | Already in stack | With breakfast                | B12 and folate are required for red blood cell production                                        |

**Important.** Iron supplementation without testing is risky if you have hemochromatosis. If you have a family history, get tested first. Otherwise, push the food protocol hard before adding the supplement.

## BREATHWORK — BHARAMARI (HUMMING BEE BREATH)

Inhale through the nose. Exhale slowly while humming, lips closed. Five rounds. Humming is the single fastest way to activate the vagus nerve — sinus nitric oxide goes up 15-fold.

MEDITATION — VISUALIZATION (10 MIN)

Eyes closed. Picture warm golden light entering through the crown of your head, filling your throat, settling at the base of your neck where your thyroid sits. Imagine it as a warm, glowing, healthy butterfly. Breathe into it.

DAILY NON-NEGOTIABLE

Eat liver once this week. Once. Pâté on toast, hidden in a burger, capsules if you absolutely cannot. Liver is the most nutrient-dense food on earth.

Week 6 Workbook

REFLECTION PROMPTS

1. Can I climb a flight of stairs without breath? Compare to Week 1.

2. How are my hands and feet — still cold, or warming?

3. What's my actual relationship with red meat — and where is it coming from culturally or emotionally?

7-DAY TRACKER

| Day | Energy stamina (1–10) | Cold extremities | Hair shedding | Restless legs | Liver eaten? |
|-----|-----------------------|------------------|---------------|---------------|--------------|
| Mon |                       |                  |               |               |              |
| Tue |                       |                  |               |               |              |
| Wed |                       |                  |               |               |              |
| Thu |                       |                  |               |               |              |
| Fri |                       |                  |               |               |              |
| Sat |                       |                  |               |               |              |
| Sun |                       |                  |               |               |              |

NOTES

## WEEK SEVEN

## The Liver Reset

*Theme: Your liver is where 60% of T4 becomes T3. Open the gates.*

Most women have a sluggish liver and don't know it. A congested liver cannot perform Phase 1 and Phase 2 detoxification efficiently — used-up estrogens, inflammatory toxins, and reverse T3 build up in circulation. This week we support the liver gently.

## HERO FOODS THIS WEEK

- Bitter greens — arugula, dandelion, watercress, endive, radicchio
- Cruciferous (cooked, not raw) — broccoli, cauliflower, Brussels sprouts, cabbage, bok choy
- Beets
- Garlic and onions
- Lemon
- Dandelion root tea

**Cruciferous and "goitrogens":** In normal portions and cooked, the goitrogenic effect is negligible and the liver-supporting compounds (sulforaphane, indole-3-carbinol) far outweigh the concern. Eat them cooked, in normal amounts, and don't worry.

## SIGNATURE MEAL

"Liver love" plate — beet and arugula salad with goat cheese, walnuts, and lemon-olive oil; roasted Brussels sprouts with garlic; baked wild salmon. Finish with a cup of dandelion root tea.

## SUPPLEMENT STACK — ADD TO EXISTING

| Supplement             | Dose     | When                       | Notes                                                   |
|------------------------|----------|----------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|
| Milk thistle           | 300 mg   | Morning                    | Phase 1 liver detox support                             |
| NAC (N-acetylcysteine) | 600 mg   | Morning, empty stomach     | Glutathione precursor; lowers TPO antibodies in studies |
| TMG (trimethylglycine) | 500 mg   | With breakfast             | Methylation support                                     |
| Dandelion root tea     | 1–2 cups | Mid-morning, mid-afternoon | Gentle bile mover                                       |

## CASTOR OIL PACK PRACTICE — 4 EVENINGS THIS WEEK

Soak a flannel cloth in cold-pressed castor oil. Place over the right side of your abdomen (over the liver). Cover with plastic, then a heating pad on low. Lie down 30 minutes. Wash skin after. Stimulates lymphatic flow and bile.

**BREATHWORK — KAPALABHATI (SKULL-SHINING BREATH, ~30 SEC)**

30 short, sharp exhales through the nose. Inhale passive, exhale active. Three rounds. Skip if pregnant, on your period, or with high blood pressure.

**MEDITATION — WALKING MEDITATION (15 MIN)**

Slow, deliberate outdoor walk. Eyes soft. Notice each step. Match your breath to your steps — inhale 4 steps, exhale 4 steps.

**DAILY NON-NEGOTIABLE**

Juice of half a lemon in warm water before anything else, every morning.

**Week 7 Workbook****REFLECTION PROMPTS**

1. What's happening on my skin this week? (Sometimes it gets worse before it gets better.)
2. Where do I feel "stuck" in my body — and where is it loosening?
3. What did the castor oil pack ritual feel like? Was I able to slow down for 30 minutes?

**7-DAY TRACKER**

| Day        | Lemon water | Bitter greens | Castor pack? | 3pm energy | PMS / hormones |
|------------|-------------|---------------|--------------|------------|----------------|
| <b>Mon</b> |             |               |              |            |                |
| <b>Tue</b> |             |               |              |            |                |
| <b>Wed</b> |             |               |              |            |                |
| <b>Thu</b> |             |               |              |            |                |
| <b>Fri</b> |             |               |              |            |                |
| <b>Sat</b> |             |               |              |            |                |
| <b>Sun</b> |             |               |              |            |                |

**NOTES**


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## WEEK EIGHT

## Mindful Iodine &amp; Protein

*Theme: The building blocks of thyroid hormone.*

Thyroid hormone is made of iodine and tyrosine, full stop. Most women in the West are mildly low in iodine despite iodized salt — but jumping to high-dose iodine if you have Hashimoto's antibodies can flare the autoimmunity. Food-first, gentle.

**Read this carefully.** If your TPO antibodies are elevated (test through your doctor or a private lab), do NOT supplement with iodine beyond what is in a multivitamin. Stick to food sources only. High-dose iodine + Hashimoto's can cause a flare.

## HERO FOODS THIS WEEK

- Wild-caught fish — cod, haddock, salmon (natural iodine)
- Seaweed — small piece of nori or 1/4 tsp kelp granules 2–3 times a week, not daily
- Pasture-raised eggs (yolk has iodine and tyrosine)
- Plain unsweetened yogurt (iodine + tyrosine)
- Pumpkin seeds, sesame seeds (tyrosine)
- Almonds, avocado (tyrosine)
- Chicken, turkey (tyrosine)

## SIGNATURE MEAL

"Thyroid sushi bowl" — short-grain brown rice, seared wild salmon, sliced avocado, soft-boiled egg, edamame, pickled ginger, a small sheet of nori, drizzle of tamari and sesame oil, sprinkle of sesame seeds.

## SUPPLEMENT STACK — ADD TO EXISTING

| Supplement              | Dose                           | When                   | Notes                                                   |
|-------------------------|--------------------------------|------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|
| L-tyrosine              | 500 mg                         | Morning, empty stomach | Skip if you have anxiety, hypertension, or are on MAOIs |
| Whole-food multivitamin | 1 capsule (iodine 100–150 mcg) | With breakfast         | Food-first for iodine; multi is the ceiling             |

## BREATHWORK — LION'S BREATH (SIMHASANA)

Inhale through nose. Open mouth wide, stick out tongue, exhale forcefully with a "haaaa." Five rounds. Mobilizes the throat and jaw — directly working the thyroid region. Impossible to do without laughing.

## MEDITATION — THROAT-FOCUSED (10 MIN)

Hand lightly on the front of the throat. Breathe in and out through the nose. Imagine each inhale gathering at the throat, each exhale softening it. If a sound or word wants to come out, let it. Notice anything held there.

DAILY NON-NEGOTIABLE

30 g of protein at breakfast. Every day. Non-negotiable for the rest of your life.

Week 8 Workbook

REFLECTION PROMPTS

- 1. Where do I hold tension in my throat? Voice, swallowing, neck, jaw?
- 2. What words have I not been saying — to myself, to others?
- 3. End of Phase 2 — what has rebuilt? What's still depleted?

7-DAY TRACKER

| Day | AM protein (g) | Throat sensation | Mood (1–10) | Cycle / hormones | Body temp |
|-----|----------------|------------------|-------------|------------------|-----------|
| Mon |                |                  |             |                  |           |
| Tue |                |                  |             |                  |           |
| Wed |                |                  |             |                  |           |
| Thu |                |                  |             |                  |           |
| Fri |                |                  |             |                  |           |
| Sat |                |                  |             |                  |           |
| Sun |                |                  |             |                  |           |

END OF PHASE 2 — WHAT'S ALREADY DIFFERENT FROM WEEK 1?

P H A S E   T H R E E   ·   W E E K S   9 – 1 2

# Regulate

*Hold the new baseline.*

WEEK NINE

# Mitochondrial Power

*Theme: Energy at the cellular level.*

By Week 9, your inflammation is down, your minerals are up, and your gut and liver are flowing. Now we wake up the mitochondria — the energy factories in every cell. Most women with thyroid dysfunction have mitochondrial fatigue layered on top of everything else.

### HERO FOODS THIS WEEK

- Wild salmon, sardines (CoQ10, omega-3)
- Grass-fed organ meats (CoQ10, B vitamins)
- Spinach, broccoli (CoQ10)
- Pasture-raised eggs (B vitamins, choline)
- Avocado (mitochondrial membrane fats)
- 85%+ dark chocolate (flavanols)

### SIGNATURE MEAL

"Mitochondria bowl" — wild salmon, roasted broccoli with garlic, half avocado, baked sweet potato with butter and cinnamon, soft-boiled egg, spinach wilted in olive oil. Finish with 2 squares of 85% dark chocolate.

### SUPPLEMENT STACK — ADD TO EXISTING

| Supplement                 | Dose         | When                      | Notes                                        |
|----------------------------|--------------|---------------------------|----------------------------------------------|
| CoQ10 (ubiquinol)          | 100–200 mg   | With breakfast (with fat) | Ubiquinol absorbs better, especially over 40 |
| Acetyl-L-carnitine         | 500–1,000 mg | Morning, empty stomach    | Often raises low T3                          |
| Alpha lipoic acid (R-form) | 200 mg       | With breakfast            | Glucose metabolism; mitochondrial function   |

### MOVEMENT PROTOCOL

Add 2 sessions of zone-2 cardio (brisk walk or easy bike — you can still hold a conversation), 30–45 min. Add 1 session of strength training (bodyweight or dumbbells), 20–30 min. Movement is medicine — but for the thyroid, do not overdo cardio. Long, intense cardio elevates cortisol and worsens conversion.

### BREATHWORK — WIM HOF (3 ROUNDS)

30 deep breaths (full inhale, passive exhale). After the 30th, exhale fully and hold as long as comfortable. Inhale, hold 15 seconds. Repeat 3 rounds. Drives mitochondrial efficiency. **Do NOT do this driving, in water, or if pregnant.**

### MEDITATION — OPEN AWARENESS (15 MIN)



No focus, no mantra. Sit. Notice whatever arises — sound, sensation, thought — and let it pass. Harder than focused meditation; builds powerful neural flexibility.

**DAILY NON-NEGOTIABLE**

End your shower with 30–60 seconds of cold water. Daily. Stimulates mitochondrial biogenesis and norepinephrine release.

Week 9 Workbook

REFLECTION PROMPTS

- 1. What does my body recover like after movement now vs. Week 1?
- 2. How is my body temperature trending? (Check basal thermometer log.)
- 3. What is the cold shower teaching me about discomfort?

7-DAY TRACKER

| Day | Movement | Cold shower (sec) | Energy stamina | Recovery (1–10) | Basal temp |
|-----|----------|-------------------|----------------|-----------------|------------|
| Mon |          |                   |                |                 |            |
| Tue |          |                   |                |                 |            |
| Wed |          |                   |                |                 |            |
| Thu |          |                   |                |                 |            |
| Fri |          |                   |                |                 |            |
| Sat |          |                   |                |                 |            |
| Sun |          |                   |                |                 |            |

NOTES

## WEEK TEN

## Hormonal Harmony

*Theme: The thyroid is not an island.*

Estrogen excess slows thyroid hormone release. Low progesterone exhausts the adrenals. Cortisol blocks T<sub>3</sub> conversion. By Week 10, if everything else is in place, we work on the hormonal symphony. Especially important if you are perimenopausal (40–55).

## HERO FOODS THIS WEEK

- Flaxseed — 1–2 tbsp ground daily (lignans bind excess estrogen)
- Pumpkin seeds (zinc, progesterone support)
- Sesame seeds (calcium, hormone support)
- Sunflower seeds (vitamin E)
- Cruciferous vegetables (DIM, sulforaphane)
- Wild salmon
- Avocado
- Maca root powder — 1 tsp in smoothie or coffee

## SEED CYCLING

**If you still cycle:** Days 1–14 (follicular) — 1 tbsp ground flax + 1 tbsp pumpkin seeds. Days 15–28 (luteal) — 1 tbsp sesame + 1 tbsp sunflower.

**If you no longer cycle:** Follow the moon. New moon to full moon — flax + pumpkin. Full moon to new moon — sesame + sunflower.

## SIGNATURE MEAL

"Hormone harmony breakfast bowl" — full-fat plain Greek yogurt, 1 tbsp ground flax, 1 tbsp pumpkin seeds, wild blueberries, drizzle of raw honey, sprinkle of cinnamon. Plus 2 pasture eggs scrambled in butter on the side.

## SUPPLEMENT STACK — ADD TO EXISTING

| Supplement                 | Dose                                        | When                   | Notes                                                                      |
|----------------------------|---------------------------------------------|------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| DIM<br>(Diindolylmethane)  | 100–200 mg                                  | With breakfast         | Healthy estrogen metabolism. Skip if cycling and progesterone already low. |
| Vitex (chasteberry)        | 400 mg                                      | Morning, empty stomach | Skip if on hormonal birth control                                          |
| Adaptogen — choose one     | Ashwagandha 600 mg /<br>Rhodiola 200–400 mg | Morning                | Ashwagandha = anxious-tired. Rhodiola = fatigued-flat.                     |
| Maca root<br>(gelatinized) | 1–3 g                                       | Morning                | Some women feel wired — start low                                          |

**Note on ashwagandha:** It is a nightshade and may worsen autoimmunity in some women. If you suspect or know you have Hashimoto's antibodies, watch for symptoms (joint pain, skin issues) and discontinue if they appear.

### **BREATHWORK — SITALI (COOLING BREATH)**

Curl your tongue (or purse lips). Inhale slowly through the curled tongue. Close mouth, exhale through the nose. Five minutes. Cools hot flashes and emotional reactivity.

### **MEDITATION — WOMB MEDITATION (15 MIN)**

Hands on lower belly. Breathe into the womb space — energetic, not anatomical, whether or not you have a uterus. Visualize a warm glow. If emotions arise, let them. Many women hold deep grief, rage, or memory in this area.

### **DAILY NON-NEGOTIABLE**

1–2 tablespoons of ground flax in something every day. Smoothie, yogurt, oatmeal — it goes anywhere.

# Week 10 Workbook

## REFLECTION PROMPTS

1. How are PMS or perimenopausal symptoms now compared to four weeks ago?
2. How is my mood across my cycle (or across the moon, if not cycling)?
3. What does my libido tell me?

## 7-DAY TRACKER

| Day | Cycle day / moon | Seeds today | Mood (1–10) | Hot flashes | Sleep |
|-----|------------------|-------------|-------------|-------------|-------|
| Mon |                  |             |             |             |       |
| Tue |                  |             |             |             |       |
| Wed |                  |             |             |             |       |
| Thu |                  |             |             |             |       |
| Fri |                  |             |             |             |       |
| Sat |                  |             |             |             |       |
| Sun |                  |             |             |             |       |

## NOTES

## WEEK ELEVEN

# Vagal Tone & Nervous System

*Theme: A regulated nervous system is non-negotiable for thyroid healing.*

You can do everything else perfectly and still not see results if your nervous system is stuck in fight-or-flight. Chronic sympathetic dominance keeps cortisol high, blocks T3 conversion, slows digestion, and disrupts sleep. The deepest work in the protocol — and arguably the most important.

## DAILY VAGAL TONING PRACTICES

1. Cold water on the face — 30 seconds, morning
2. Vigorous gargle with water — 30 seconds, after brushing teeth
3. Hum or sing — 5 minutes daily
4. Eye exercises — gaze far, near, circles. 5 minutes.
5. Walk in nature — 20 minutes minimum, no phone

## HERO FOODS THIS WEEK (GUT-VAGUS AXIS)

- Continue all fermented foods
- Bone broth daily
- Wild salmon, sardines (omega-3 — vagal nerve myelination)
- Raw cacao (magnesium, mood)
- Blueberries (anthocyanins — neuroprotective)
- Green tea (L-theanine — calming alpha brainwaves)

## SIGNATURE MEAL

A slow-cooked, parasympathetic meal. Sunday-roast style. Pasture chicken, root vegetables roasted in ghee, sautéed greens with garlic, bone broth on the side. Set the table beautifully. No phones. No TV. Light a candle. Eat for 30 minutes minimum. This is medicine.

## SUPPLEMENT STACK

Maintain your stack. **Do not add anything new this week.** The work is behavioral.

## BREATHWORK — LONG EXHALE

Inhale 4. Exhale 8. Twenty rounds. Twice daily. The exhale is when the parasympathetic nervous system engages. Doubling the exhale doubles the down-regulation.

## MEDITATION — TRAUMA-SENSITIVE (3X THIS WEEK, 20 MIN)

If you have a history of trauma — most women do, more than they realize — seated meditation may not be the right entry point. Try slow yin yoga, somatic experiencing, or trauma-sensitive yoga (look up Bessel van der Kolk or David Emerson).

## DAILY NON-NEGOTIABLE

Twenty minutes outside, in nature, alone, no phone. Every single day this week.

# Week 11 Workbook

## REFLECTION PROMPTS

1. *What does my nervous system feel like at rest? Can I tell?*
2. *How easily am I triggered now compared to four weeks ago?*
3. *Where does my stress actually live in my body?*

## 7-DAY TRACKER

| Day | Resting HR (AM) | HRV (if tracked) | Reactivity (1–10) | Time outside | Sleep onset (min) |
|-----|-----------------|------------------|-------------------|--------------|-------------------|
| Mon |                 |                  |                   |              |                   |
| Tue |                 |                  |                   |              |                   |
| Wed |                 |                  |                   |              |                   |
| Thu |                 |                  |                   |              |                   |
| Fri |                 |                  |                   |              |                   |
| Sat |                 |                  |                   |              |                   |
| Sun |                 |                  |                   |              |                   |

## NOTES

WEEK  
TWELVE

# Integration & Your New Baseline

*Theme: This is not a 90-day diet. This is the rest of your life.*

You are not starting over on Day 91. You are choosing what stays. Most women who finish a 90-day protocol slide back within 60 days — because they treated it as a sprint instead of a transformation. This week we set the integration plan.

## 1. SYMPTOM INVENTORY

Pull out your journal from Week 1 and Week 12. Compare. Write down every symptom that improved: energy, sleep quality, body temperature trend, hair, skin, nails, bowel movements, mood, cycle, weight, waist, cravings, mental clarity. This is your evidence. You will need it on the days you doubt yourself.

## 2. RECOMMENDED RETESTING (OR FIRST LABS IF YOU DIDN'T TEST AT START)

- TSH, Free T4, Free T3, Reverse T3
- TPO antibodies, Tg antibodies
- Ferritin, vitamin D, B12
- Fasting insulin, fasting glucose, HbA1c
- hsCRP (inflammation)

Bring results to a functional medicine practitioner or thyroid-literate doctor. Standard TSH-only screening is not enough.

## 3. IDENTIFY YOUR TOP 5 KEEPERS

Of all the practices, foods, and supplements you did over 90 days, which 5 made the biggest difference? These become your non-negotiables forever.

## 4. BUILD YOUR MAINTENANCE STACK

Most women maintain on:

- Magnesium glycinate (lifetime)
- Vitamin D3 + K2 (test 2x year)
- Omega-3 (lifetime)
- Methylated B-complex (lifetime)
- Selenium 100–200 mcg, 5 days a week
- Adaptogen rotation — 3 months on, 1 month off

Drop iron once ferritin is over 70 ng/mL. Drop berberine once blood sugar is stable. Drop NAC and milk thistle after 3 months unless your liver markers indicate ongoing need.

## 5. PLAN YOUR NEXT CYCLE

Most women repeat the 90-day protocol once a year — typically in late winter when energy is naturally low. Some do a "mini-reset" (the first 4 weeks) every 3–6 months.

### **DAILY NON-NEGOTIABLES (FOREVER)**

1. Morning sunlight within 30 minutes of waking
2. 30 g protein at breakfast
3. Walk 10 minutes after dinner
4. 8 hours of sleep
5. One fermented food
6. Daily breathwork (5 min minimum)
7. Daily meditation (10 min minimum)
8. Phone off the bedside table



# Week 12 Workbook — Integration Map

## MY BEFORE-AND-AFTER — WEEK 1 VS. WEEK 12

| Symptom                 | Week 1 | Week 12 |
|-------------------------|--------|---------|
| Energy (1–10)           |        |         |
| Sleep quality (1–10)    |        |         |
| Basal body temp average |        |         |
| Hair, skin, nails       |        |         |
| Bowel movements         |        |         |
| Mood / mental clarity   |        |         |
| Cycle / hormones        |        |         |
| Weight / waist          |        |         |
| Cravings                |        |         |

## MY TOP 5 KEEPERS

1.
2.
3.
4.
5.

## MY MAINTENANCE SUPPLEMENT STACK

## WHAT I AM COMMITTING TO FOREVER

## WHAT I'LL COME BACK TO (MINI-RESET OR FULL REPEAT — WHEN?)

|  |
|--|
|  |
|--|

# Appendix A — Recommended Labs

## BASIC THYROID PANEL — ALWAYS ORDER

- TSH — target under 2.0  $\mu$ IU/mL for symptomatic women
- Free T<sub>4</sub>
- Free T<sub>3</sub>
- Reverse T<sub>3</sub> (rT<sub>3</sub>)
- TPO antibodies
- Tg antibodies

## SUPPORTIVE MARKERS — HIGHLY RECOMMENDED

- Ferritin — target 70–100 ng/mL (well above standard "normal" floor)
- Vitamin D, 25-OH — target 50–80 ng/mL
- B<sub>12</sub> — target above 500 pg/mL
- Folate
- Fasting insulin — target under 5  $\mu$ IU/mL
- Fasting glucose
- HbA<sub>1c</sub> — target under 5.4%
- hsCRP — target under 1.0 mg/L

## HORMONAL PANEL — IF PERIMENOPAUSAL OR SYMPTOMATIC

- Estradiol, progesterone, testosterone (free and total), DHEA-S
- Cortisol — ideally a 4-point salivary test
- LH, FSH

## OPTIONAL BUT POWERFUL

- Iodine spot urine test
- Selenium blood level
- Zinc/copper ratio
- Comprehensive stool analysis
- Organic acids test (mitochondrial markers)

## Appendix B — When to Escalate

### GET MEDICAL EVALUATION IMMEDIATELY IF

- Resting heart rate over 100
- Palpitations or new arrhythmia
- Severe fatigue worsening despite the protocol
- Sudden, unexplained weight loss
- Visible neck swelling or trouble swallowing
- Worsening depression or thoughts of self-harm
- TSH over 10 or under 0.4 on testing
- TPO antibodies over 500
- Persistent puffiness around the eyes, severe cold intolerance, or slowed reflexes

### STRONGLY CONSIDER WORKING WITH A FUNCTIONAL MEDICINE PRACTITIONER IF

- After 90 days, symptoms have not meaningfully improved
- Labs show persistent dysfunction
- You have multiple autoimmune conditions
- You are perimenopausal with significant hormone disruption layered on thyroid issues

This protocol is a starting point. It is not the ceiling. Most women feel dramatically better in 90 days. Some need deeper work.

## A Note from Reham

I built this protocol because I built one for myself.

After my LADA diagnosis at 44, I realized that everything I had been told about my body — by doctors, by the wellness industry, by my own fear — was either incomplete or wrong.

I am not telling you to skip your doctor. I am telling you that food, sleep, breath, and minerals are medicine. They are slow medicine. They are not as glamorous as a pill or as fast as a procedure. But they work.

Use this protocol as a foundation. Track your symptoms. See your doctor. Get your labs. Decide for yourself, with information instead of fear.

**You are not broken. You are depleted. There is a difference.**

— *Reham*

LIV Functional

# Disclaimer

This protocol is for educational purposes only and is not intended to diagnose, treat, cure, or prevent any disease. Reham Alsharif is a certified holistic nutrition coach and is not a licensed medical professional. The information in this protocol does not replace medical advice from a qualified healthcare provider. Always consult your doctor before starting any new supplement, exercise, or dietary program — especially if you are pregnant, breastfeeding, taking prescription medications, or have a diagnosed medical condition. By using this protocol, you agree that LIV Functional and Reham Alsharif are not liable for any outcomes related to your use of this material.

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